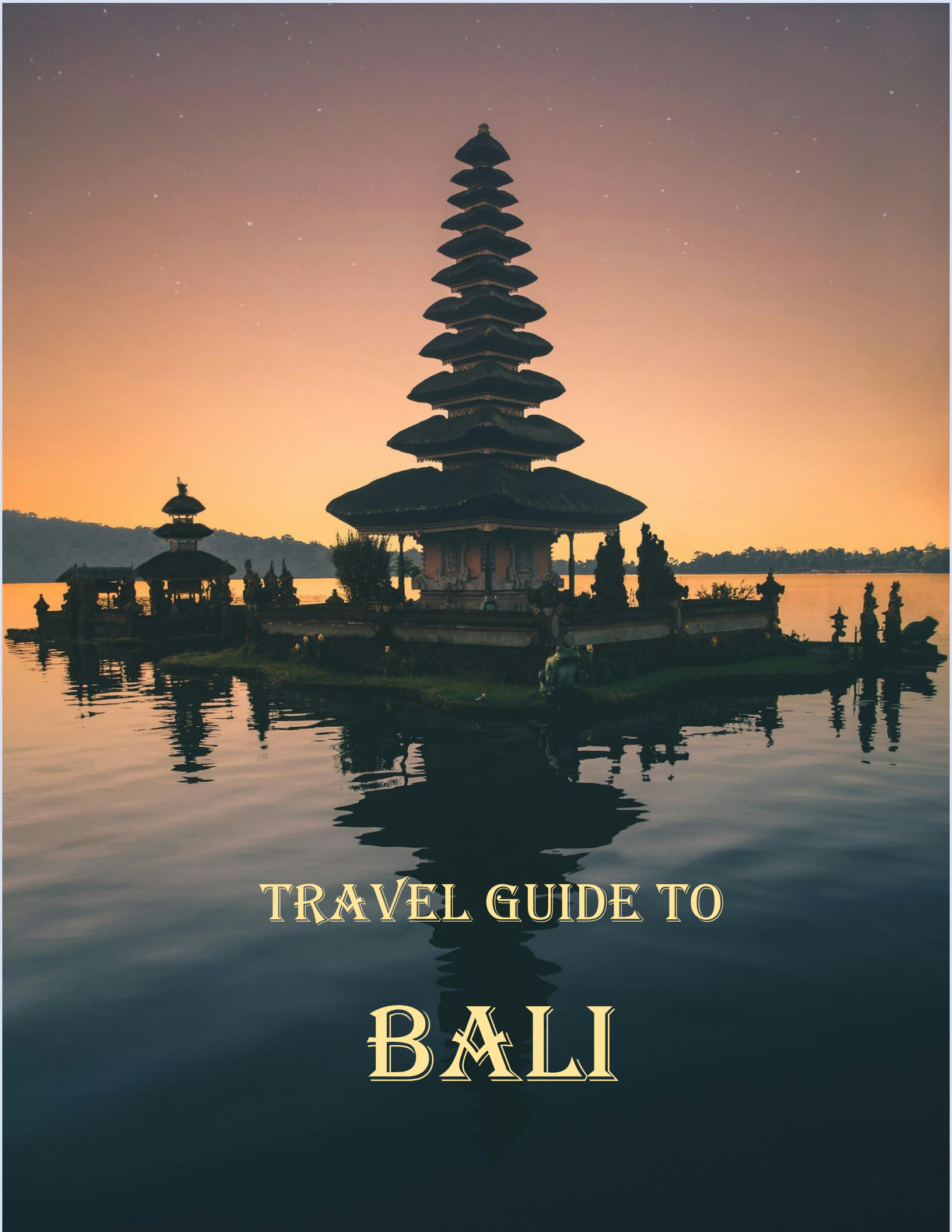




TRAVEL GUIDE TO

BALI

Why Bali

Bali does not just welcome visitors—it embraces them. It is an island of sacred rituals and endless waves, where the scent of frangipani flowers mingles with the smoke of incense from thousand-year-old temples. From the emerald rice terraces of Ubud to the dramatic clifftops of Uluwatu, Bali transforms those who step onto its shores.

It is not just a holiday—it is a spiritual awakening. Bali is calling. Answer it.

About Bali

- **Climate**

Tropical year-round (27–30°C). Dry season: April–October. Rainy: November–March. Best months: May, June, September.

- **Currency**

Indonesian Rupiah (IDR). 1 USD ≈ 15,500–16,000 IDR. Cards accepted in hotels, but carry cash for markets.

- **Safety**

Generally safe. Watch for pickpockets in crowds. Emergency: **110**. Keep valuables secure and avoid carrying passports unnecessarily.

- **Vaccinations**

No mandatory jabs. Recommended: Hepatitis A, Typhoid, Rabies (due to monkeys/dogs), Japanese Encephalitis.

- **Entry Requirements**

Most nationalities get **Visa on Arrival (VOA)** – ~\$32–35 USD, valid 30 days, extendable once. e-VOA available online.

- **Time Zone**

UTC+8 (WITA). No Daylight-Saving Time.

- **Transportation**

Grab/Gojek for scooters. Private drivers for day trips (~IDR 800,000). Scooter rentals (IDR 70,000–100,000/day, require international permit). Fast boats to islands.

- **Language**

Bahasa Indonesia. English widely spoken in tourist areas. Learn: "**Terima kasih**" (Thank you) and "**Selamat pagi**" (Good morning).

- **Cuisine**

Babi Guling (suckling pig), Nasi Goreng, Sate Lilit, Gado-Gado. Eat at **warungs** for authentic flavours.

- **Cultural Etiquette**

Wear sarong/sash at temples. Don't touch heads. Use right hand for giving/receiving. Dress modestly. Learn a few local phrases.

- **Attractions**

Tanah Lot, Uluwatu Temple, Tegallalang Rice Terraces, Mount Batur, Ubud Monkey Forest, Jatiluwih, Tirta Empul, Nusa Penida, Gili Islands.

Travelers Must See



Tanah Lot – The Temple on the Sea

Imagine a temple perched on a rocky islet, surrounded by the crashing waves of the Indian Ocean. This is Tanah Lot, Bali's most photographed sea temple. As the sun sets behind its silhouette, the sky erupts in shades of gold and crimson, and the waves roar beneath your feet. It is not just a temple—it is a dance between land and sea, where the spiritual meets the eternal.

Uluwatu Temple & The Kecak Fire Dance

On a sheer cliff 70 metres above the ocean, Uluwatu Temple stands as a guardian of the southern coast. Monkeys roam the grounds, and the sound of the waves echoes from far below. As dusk falls, the Kecak Fire Dance begins—a hypnotic performance of chanting men, flickering torches, and ancient stories brought to life. It is Bali's most unforgettable cultural spectacle.





Tegallalang Rice Terraces

Step into a postcard. The Tegallalang Rice Terraces cascade down the hillsides of Ubud in a symphony of emerald greens. These ancient irrigation systems, known as subak, have been cultivated for over a thousand years. Walking through these terraces, you feel the rhythm of Balinese life—patient, harmonious, and deeply connected to the earth.

Mount Batur – The Sunrise Volcano

Long before the sun rises, hikers begin their climb up the slopes of Mount Batur, an active volcano towering over the island. It is a two-hour ascent through the darkness, but the reward is nothing short of magical. As the first rays of light pierce the horizon, the world below awakens—a sea of clouds, a shimmering lake, and the silhouette of neighbouring volcanoes. This is Bali at its most raw and beautiful.



Ubud Monkey Forest



Deep in the heart of Ubud, a sacred forest sanctuary is home to over 700 long-tailed macaques. Ancient temples peek through the dense jungle, and mischievous monkeys swing from the trees.

Walking through the Monkey Forest feels like stepping into a mystical realm where nature and spirituality are inseparable. Hold onto your sunglasses—these playful residents are known for their curiosity!

Jatiluwi Rice Terraces



Unlike the more famous Tegallalang, the Jatiluwi Rice Terraces stretch across the hillsides in a vast, breathtaking expanse. Recognised as a UNESCO World Heritage site, these terraces are a masterpiece of agricultural engineering and natural beauty. Here, the green stretches as far as the eye can see, and the quiet is broken only by the whisper of the wind through the rice paddies.

Tirta Empul – The Holy Water Temple



For over a thousand years, Balinese Hindus have come to Tirta Empul to purify their bodies and souls in its sacred spring water. Visitors can participate in the purification ritual—stepping into the cool, crystal-clear pools and letting the water wash over them. It is a deeply moving experience, a connection to a tradition that has survived for centuries.

Nusa Penida – The Island of Giants



Just a short boat ride from Bali lies Nusa Penida, an island of rugged cliffs, turquoise waters, and dramatic landscapes. Here, you will find Kelingking Beach—a viewpoint that resembles a T-Rex head diving into the ocean. The snorkelling and diving here are world-class, with manta rays and vibrant coral reefs waiting beneath the surface. Nusa Penida is raw, untamed, and utterly unforgettable.

Seminyak & Canggu – The Beach Vibe



For those who crave sun, surf, and sunset cocktails, Seminyak and Canggu are the places to be. Seminyak offers chic beach clubs, upscale boutiques, and fine dining, while Canggu has a more laid-back, bohemian vibe. Both are perfect for watching the sun dip below the horizon, surfboards in hand, and the sound of waves filling the air.

The Gili Islands – Paradise Found



A short fast-boat ride from Bali takes you to the Gili Islands—three tiny islands with no motorised vehicles, just horse-drawn carts and bicycles. The water is impossibly turquoise, the coral reefs are vibrant, and the pace of life is gloriously slow. Snorkel with sea turtles, cycle around the island, or simply lie in a hammock and do nothing at all. This is paradise, pure and simple.

Activities To Do

*Bali is a playground for the adventurous soul.
Here are the most unforgettable experiences the
Island of the Gods has to offer:*



Snorkel with Manta Rays at Nusa Penida

Beneath the turquoise waters of Nusa Penida, giant manta rays glide through the ocean with effortless grace. Snorkelling alongside these gentle giants is a humbling experience—a reminder of the beauty that lies beneath the surface. The coral reefs are vibrant, the fish are plentiful, and the water is crystal clear. It is an underwater adventure you will never forget.



Hike an Active Volcano at Sunrise

Mount Batur's sunrise trek is Bali's signature adventure. The climb begins in darkness, but as you reach the summit, the sky transforms into a canvas of pink, orange, and gold. Below, the caldera lake shimmers, and the distant peaks of Mount Agung and Mount Rinjani rise above the clouds. It is a two-hour climb that rewards you with a lifetime of memories.



Surf the Waves at Kuta or Canggu

Bali's waves are legendary. Whether you are a beginner catching your first foam wave at Kuta or an experienced surfer tackling the breaks at Uluwatu, the island offers some of the best surfing in the world. The warm water, the tropical sun, and the vibrant surf culture make every session an unforgettable experience.



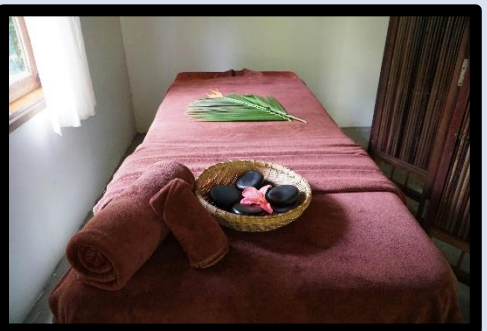
Raft Through the Ayung River

Hold on tight! White-water rafting on the Ayung River in Ubud is an adrenaline rush like no other. As you navigate through rapids and cascading waterfalls, you will be surrounded by lush jungle, towering cliffs, and ancient carvings. It is a wild ride through the heart of Bali's natural beauty.



Cycle Through the Rice Terraces

For a slower pace, rent a bicycle and explore the back roads of Ubud. Cycle past emerald rice paddies, traditional villages, and hidden temples. The air is fresh, the scenery is breathtaking, and every turn reveals a new postcard-perfect view.



Relax with a Balinese Massage

After all that adventure, treat yourself to a traditional Balinese massage. Using a combination of gentle stretches, acupressure, and aromatic oils, this ancient healing practice will leave you feeling completely rejuvenated. Many spas offer massages with views of the rice fields or the ocean—pure bliss.



Witness the Kecak Fire Dance at Uluwatu

As the sun sets over the Indian Ocean, a circle of men begins to chant in hypnotic rhythm—"cak, cak, cak"—their voices rising and falling like a living orchestra. This is the Kecak Fire Dance, a performance that tells the story of the Ramayana through movement, music, and fire. With the ocean as its backdrop and the flames flickering in the darkness, it is Bali's most unforgettable cultural experience.

Participate in a Temple Purification Ceremony

At Tirta Empul, visitors are invited to step into the sacred spring water and participate in a purification ritual that has been performed for over a thousand years. As you stand beneath the cool water, you feel a profound sense of peace—a connection to something greater than yourself. It is not just a tourist activity; it is a spiritual journey.



Learn Balinese Cooking in Ubud

Bali's cuisine is a reflection of its culture—vibrant, complex, and deeply rooted in tradition. Join a cooking class in Ubud and learn to prepare dishes like Nasi Goreng, Sate Lilit, and Gado-Gado. You will visit a local market, learn about the spices, and cook a feast using traditional techniques. It is a delicious way to connect with Balinese culture.





Nyepi – The Day of Silence

Imagine an entire island falling silent. No lights, no noise, no activity. This is Nyepi, Bali's most sacred holiday—a day of complete silence, fasting, and meditation to mark the Balinese New Year. The night before, the streets come alive with the **Ogoh-Ogoh Parade**, where giant demonic effigies are carried through the streets and burned to drive away evil spirits. Then, silence descends. It is one of the most unique cultural experiences on earth.

Date: March 19



Bali Arts Festival – The Island's Cultural Heart

Running for nearly a month, the Bali Arts Festival is the island's largest cultural event. Thousands of artists, dancers, and musicians from across Indonesia and beyond come together to celebrate Balinese heritage. From June 13 to July 11, the festival showcases traditional performances, art exhibitions, and parades that bring the streets of Denpasar to life.

Date: June 13 – July 11



Bali Spirit Festival – Yoga, Music, and Healing

In the lush jungles of Ubud, the Bali Spirit Festival brings together yogis, musicians, and healers from around the world. It is a celebration of holistic living, with yoga classes, ecstatic dance, and live music. Whether you are a seasoned yogi or a curious beginner, this festival will leave you feeling inspired and rejuvenated.

Date: April 22–26



Ubud Food Festival – A Culinary Celebration

For food lovers, the Ubud Food Festival is a must. Chefs, farmers, and food enthusiasts gather to celebrate Bali's rich culinary heritage. From cooking demonstrations to market tours and tasting sessions, this festival is a feast for the senses. It is a delicious way to experience the island's vibrant food culture.

Date: May/June

Galungan & Kuningan – The Victory of Good Over Evil

Twice a year, Bali celebrates Galungan—a festival marking the victory of dharma (good) over adharma (evil). During this ten-day period, the island is adorned with towering bamboo poles called *penjor*, and families gather to pray and offer thanks. It is a time of joy, reflection, and community—a beautiful glimpse into the spiritual heart of Bali.

Date: Varies (Balinese calendar)



Cities Must Visit



Ubud – The Cultural Heart

Ubud is the soul of Bali. Surrounded by emerald rice terraces and ancient temples, this town is a haven for artists, yogis, and spiritual seekers. Wander through the Sacred Monkey Forest, visit the Ubud Palace, and explore the vibrant art markets. Ubud is where Bali's culture comes alive.

Best time: April–October

Seminyak – Chic & Sophisticated

Seminyak is Bali's most fashionable beach town. Trendy boutiques, world-class restaurants, and glamorous beach clubs line its streets. Watch the sunset from a chic lounge, indulge in fine dining, and soak up the sophisticated energy. Seminyak is for those who want luxury with a side of surf.

Best time: April–October



Canggu – Bohemian Beach Vibe

Canggu is where the surf meets the rice fields. This laid-back village has a bohemian, alternative vibe—think vegan cafés, co-working spaces, and beachfront yoga shalas. The black-sand beaches are perfect for surfing, and the sunsets are legendary. Canggu is for the free-spirited traveller.

Best time: April–October

Kuta – The Classic Surf Town

Kuta is Bali's original beach destination. Famous for its long, sandy beach and consistent waves, it is the perfect place to learn surfing. The nightlife is vibrant, the shopping is cheap, and the energy is electric. Kuta is for those who want to experience Bali's classic beach town vibe.

Best time: April–October



Uluwatu – Clifftop Serenity

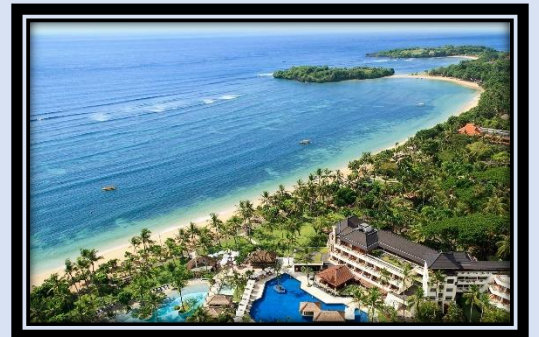
Perched on the dramatic cliffs of Bali's southern coast, Uluwatu is a place of breathtaking beauty. Here, you will find the iconic Uluwatu Temple, world-class surf breaks, and luxurious clifftop resorts. The sunsets here are nothing short of magical.

Best time: April–October

Nusa Dua – Luxury & Tranquillity

Nusa Dua is Bali's enclave of luxury. With its pristine beaches, five-star resorts, and world-class golf courses, it is the perfect destination for those seeking relaxation and refinement. The calm waters are ideal for swimming, and the manicured gardens offer a peaceful escape.

Best time: April–October



Where To Stay

Imagine that every hotel in Bali is a portal to a different world. Some carry you into the lush jungles of Ubud, others place you on dramatic clifftops overlooking the ocean, and many offer the warmth of Balinese hospitality without weighing down your budget. Bali is not just a destination; it is a living canvas of accommodations, each telling a unique story.



- In **Ubud**, the **Four Seasons Resort Bali at Sayan** is an icon—arrive via a dramatic lotus-pond rooftop entrance, with villas suspended over a river gorge. Nearby, **The Kayon Jungle Resort** offers similar jungle aesthetics at a fraction of the cost.
- In **Uluwatu**, the **Bulgari Resort** sits on dramatic clifftops with breathtaking ocean views.
- In **Nusa Dua**, the **St. Regis Bali Resort** delivers unparalleled beachfront luxury.
- In **Seminyak**, the **W Bali** offers chic beachfront style with a vibrant social scene.

Explore More & Book Hotel



If you are looking for quality at a reasonable price, Bali is filled with hidden gems:

- **Best Western Kuta Beach** – reliable, with a rooftop pool and beachfront location.
- **Puri Cendana Resort Bali** – a peaceful retreat in the heart of Seminyak.
- **Abimana Ubud** – a budget-friendly gem surrounded by rice fields.
- **The Kayon Jungle Resort** – jungle luxury at 30% less cost than the top-tier resorts.
- **Legong Keraton Beach Hotel** – affordable beachfront stay in the heart of the action.
- **Local homestays** – for as little as \$20–\$30/night, you can stay with a Balinese family and experience true island hospitality.

Explore More & Book Hotel

Food



Imagine Bali as one giant kitchen, where the scent of sizzling satay, fragrant spices, and fresh coconut fills the air. Every dish tells a story—of ancient traditions, vibrant markets, and the island's deep connection to the land and sea. Food here is not just fuel; it is a celebration of life itself.



In Bali, every meal is a journey—across markets, across generations, and into the hearts of those who have perfected these flavours over centuries. Whether you are savouring Babi Guling in a humble warung, biting into a fresh seafood satay, or enjoying a plant-based feast in a trendy Ubud café, you are not just eating—you are tasting the soul of the island.



From humble warungs to jungle-framed fine dining, dining in Bali is never just a meal—it is an experience. In Ubud, Locavore consistently ranks among Asia's best restaurants, creating stunning tasting menus using exclusively Indonesian ingredients. Mozaic offers French-Balinese fusion in a romantic garden setting that feels like dining in a dream. On the clifftops of Uluwatu, Il Ristorante – Niko Romito serves world-class Italian cuisine with ocean views. And in Seminyak, Starfish Bloo offers a lavish brunch buffet with lobster, sushi, and local delights.



Yet the true soul of Balinese dining lives in the bustling warungs—family-run eateries where steaming plates of Nasi Goreng and sizzling satay tell stories passed down through generations. Whether you seek Michelin-worthy artistry or the comforting chaos of a local food stall, every meal in Bali is a journey through the island's rich culinary heritage.



Transportations



Private Driver

The gold standard for day trips. Hire a driver for approximately IDR 800,000 and explore the island in comfort.

[Get Ticket](#)



Grab & Gojek Apps

Bali's version of Uber. Order a scooter ("Gride") for the fastest way through traffic. Cashless and convenient.

[Get Ticket](#)



Scooter Rental

The most popular way to explore Bali. Rent a scooter for around IDR 70,000–100,000 per day. Requires an international driving permit—and caution.

[Get Ticket](#)



Fast Boat to the Islands

Hop on a fast boat to Nusa Penida, Lembongan, or the Gili Islands. Turquoise waters and island adventures await.

[Get Ticket](#)



Public Buses

Trans Metro Dewata buses require an E-Money card (cash no longer accepted). Affordable and growing more extensive.

When To Go

Bali does not have one season—it has two, and each offers a different invitation to explore.

Dry Season:

(April to October) is Bali at its most radiant. The skies are clear, the sun is warm, and the ocean is calm. This is the perfect time for surfing, diving, trekking, and exploring the island's temples. **May, June, and September** are particularly special—dry weather, fewer crowds than July and August, and hotels eager to fill rooms at competitive rates.

Rainy Season:

(**November to March**) brings brief but heavy afternoon showers. The island turns lush and green, the waterfalls are at their most powerful, and the crowds thin out. It is a quieter, more introspective time to visit—perfect for those who don't mind a little rain.

A final secret:

July and August are the busiest months. For the best balance of weather and peace, aim for **May, June, or September**.

Plan Your Trip

Every great journey begins with a single decision—the moment you stop dreaming and start planning.

Bali is not a destination you simply visit; it is a story you step into. From the moment you land, you are no longer a spectator—you become part of a living legend. Imagine watching the sunset from a clifftop temple, the waves crashing beneath you. Picture yourself hiking an active volcano at sunrise, the world awakening below. Envision the taste of fresh satay from a street-side warung as the sound of gamelan fills the air.

But here is the secret: the best adventures are not left to chance. They are crafted. They are planned. They are booked.

With just a few clicks, you can unlock a world of wonders—from the emerald rice terraces of Ubud to the turquoise waters of Nusa Penida. Flights, hotels, tours, and experiences are all within your reach. A private driver is waiting to take you across the island. A cooking class is ready to teach you the secrets of Balinese cuisine. And the waves are calling your name.

The question is not if you will go—but when and how.

Do not wait for the perfect moment. Create it. Bali is calling, and its stories are waiting to be written—by you.

Discover and search for the best travel deals to Bali. Your adventure begins with one click.

Plan Your Trip

[Booking.com](#) is the world's leading online travel platform, offering an unparalleled selection of over 1.5 million properties. From hotels and motels to vacation rentals and holiday homes, it connects travelers with the perfect place to stay anywhere in the world.

[Book Now](#)

[Tripadvisor](#) is the world's largest travel guidance platform. With over one billion reviews and contributions from travelers worldwide, it helps millions of people discover, plan, and book the perfect trip. Whether you're looking for hotels, restaurants, flights, or experiences, Tripadvisor brings together trusted guidance from real travelers to help you make confident decisions.

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